

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Legal Assistant role at HB Public Law in Adult Social Care appeals to me because it sits at the intersection of legal process and public protection, which is where most of my practical experience has been focused. My background spans case preparation, client-facing advisory work and procedural document management, and I have worked directly with vulnerable individuals in legally complex situations.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I currently manage matters end to end across welfare benefits, housing, employment and family law. That means taking detailed factual statements from clients, identifying evidential and procedural issues, drafting correspondence and applications, and maintaining confidential case records to deadline. Many of my clients are in difficult personal circumstances, so I have developed a careful, clear approach to communicating procedural requirements in terms that are actually useful to someone under pressure. That combination of file management, client communication and attention to eligibility criteria maps directly onto what a legal assistant supporting Adult Social Care casework would be doing day to day.

During my year at BCLP, I spent six months in International Arbitration and six months in Real Estate Disputes. In the arbitration team I became, for a period, the only junior supporting a complex investment arbitration matter approaching a significant submission deadline. I tracked outstanding actions, coordinated documents and helped ensure on-time filing. In Real Estate Disputes I prepared electronic court bundles, maintained matter records via iManage, assisted with skeleton arguments and managed large volumes of documents across competing deadlines. Both rotations required exactly the kind of organised, deadline-driven case file management that this role describes.

HB Public Law's structure as a shared service across several North West London boroughs is something I find genuinely interesting. Adult Social Care work involves statutory decision-making under real pressure, with direct consequences for vulnerable people. That is the kind of legal environment I have been deliberately moving towards, and this role would give me structured exposure to local authority practice in a team where the legal work clearly has public protection at its centre.

I am available to start promptly and am happy to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva